Slow Cooked Roast Beef with Mustard Purée

FROM NELL'S KITCHEN

This is a generous, comforting dish to bring to the family table. The beef cooks gently with three kinds of mustard, warm spices, vegetables and red wine.

Serves 8–10 · Prep 25 min · Cook 3 h

INGREDIENTS

FOR THE ONION STOCK

- 2 tbsp olive oil
- 1 medium onion, cut into thin wedges
- 2 litres water

FOR THE BEEF

- 2 kg beef silverside, tied with butcher's string
- 2 tbsp butter
- 2 tbsp olive oil
- 1 tbsp yellow mustard
- 1 tbsp wholegrain mustard (moutarde à l'ancienne)
- 1 tbsp Dijon mustard
- 1 tsp ground cinnamon
- 1 tsp Lebanese seven-spice
- 1 tsp ground nutmeg
- 2 tbsp oregano
- 3 bay leaves
- 2 cinnamon sticks
- 2 medium tomatoes, roughly chopped
- 2 medium carrots, peeled and cut into chunks
- 1 medium onion, cut into wedges
- 1 cup red wine, alcoholic or non-alcoholic
- Prepared onion stock, as needed
- Salt, to taste

FOR THE MUSTARD PURÉE

- 2 kg potatoes, peeled and cut into evenly sized chunks
- 100 g butter
- 1–1½ cups warm milk, added gradually
- 2 tbsp wholegrain mustard, adjusted to taste
- ¼ tsp ground nutmeg
- Salt and freshly ground black pepper, to taste
- Extra-virgin olive oil, for finishing

METHOD

1. Prepare the onion stock. Heat the olive oil in a saucepan over medium heat. Add the sliced onion and cook, stirring regularly, until very dark brown but not burnt. Carefully add the water, bring to the boil and simmer for approximately 10 minutes, until the stock takes on a deep brown colour.
2. Season the beef. Mix the yellow mustard, wholegrain mustard, Dijon, ground cinnamon, seven-spice, nutmeg and oregano. Rub all over the beef.
3. Brown the beef. Heat the butter and olive oil in a large, heavy casserole over medium-high heat. Sear the beef for a couple of minutes on each side, adjusting the heat so the mustard coating does not burn.
4. Add the vegetables and liquid. Add the tomatoes, carrots, onion, bay leaves and cinnamon sticks. Pour in the wine and enough onion stock to come approximately halfway to two-thirds up the beef. Reserve the remaining stock.
5. Cook gently. Bring to a gentle simmer, cover and reduce the heat to low. Cook for approximately 1½–2½ hours, turning the beef occasionally and checking the liquid level. Add more stock if needed. Start checking tenderness after 1½ hours: a fork should slide in and pull out easily. Continue cooking gently if the meat still feels firm, allowing additional time as needed.
6. Prepare the potatoes. Towards the end of the beef's cooking time, place the potatoes in a large saucepan of salted water. Bring to the boil and cook until very tender. Drain thoroughly and let the steam escape for a minute or two.
7. Make the purée. Mash the potatoes until smooth. Fold in the butter, then gradually add enough warm milk to reach your preferred consistency. Stir in the wholegrain mustard, nutmeg, salt and pepper. Keep warm.
8. Finish the sauce. Transfer the cooked beef to a board, cover loosely and rest for 10–15 minutes. Remove the bay leaves and cinnamon sticks from the casserole. Blend the vegetables and cooking liquid with a hand blender until smooth. If the sauce is too thin, simmer uncovered to reduce; if too thick, add a little reserved stock. Taste and adjust the salt.
9. Serve. Remove the butcher's string and slice the beef thinly across the grain. Serve with the mustard purée, a drizzle of olive oil over the potatoes and generous spoonfuls of sauce.

Tip

Add stock according to your pot. You may not need the full two litres; keep the remainder for topping up or adjusting the sauce.